

Why these six variants?

Selection rationale and validation plan | Prepared for Abhishek | Research snapshot: September 2026

Decision: freeze six Gold ORB configurations for comparison. They are a small experiment that separates timing, stop size and the effect of the upper range limit. They are not six equally strong systems, or six strategies to trade together.

ID	Stop ATR	Entry start	Range filter	Purpose
A	0.25	07:05	OFF	Lower-DD narrow-stop baseline
B	0.25	07:05	0.00-0.60	Check whether filtering helps that baseline
C	0.25	07:30	OFF	Higher-return narrow-stop baseline
D	0.25	07:30	0.00-0.60	Filtered narrow-stop challenger
E	0.65	07:30	OFF	Wide-stop comparison baseline
F	0.65	07:30	0.00-0.60	Leading filtered wide-stop candidate

All six retain the time filter, with entry ending before 08:55 broker time. The range-building period remains 03:05-06:05 and scheduled exit remains 18:55. A zero minimum does not switch the range filter off: the 0.60 maximum still applies.

The current preference

For 0.25 ATR, retain A and C as the main choices until validation shows whether the filtered versions justify their lost return. For 0.65 ATR, F is the leading candidate because it retains 94.4% of E's net profit while reducing observed relative equity DD from 10.60% to 6.93%.

Evidence: the earlier five-variant analysis, three supplied optimization screenshots (24 displayed rows each, with repeated parameter sets), and the user-reported 12% DD for unfiltered 0.65 at 07:05. Screenshot figures are transcribed summaries, not independently reconstructed new trade ledgers. Comparisons assume identical dates, sizing, costs and modelling settings.

What the six-way design answers

A controlled shortlist rather than an expanding search for the best historical number

Comparison	Question answered
A versus B	At stop 0.25 and start 07:05, does adding a maximum range of 0.60 improve the return-risk trade-off?
C versus D	At stop 0.25 and start 07:30, does that same upper range limit earn its place?
A versus C	Without a range filter, is earlier eligibility worth the different return and drawdown path?
B versus D	Does the preferred timing change when the same range cap is active?
E versus F	At stop 0.65 and start 07:30, does the cap improve risk with little sacrifice of return?
A/C versus E/F	How do the narrow and wide stops differ? Equal risk settings do not imply equal realized account volatility.

The 0.25 selection is a complete two-by-two comparison: two entry starts multiplied by filter OFF/ON. The 0.65 selection is one matched OFF/ON pair at the currently stronger filtered timing. This is enough to answer the immediate decisions without retesting every threshold.

Why retain B despite its weak headline result? It completes the timing/filter comparison and may reveal an improvement in recovery duration or difficult years that the aggregate screenshot cannot show. B has a lower priority than A, C and F; its inclusion is an audit of the decision, not an endorsement.

Why keep E? Without an unfiltered control, F's lower drawdown could be mistaken for a universal improvement. E shows exactly what return and activity are sacrificed by adding the range cap.

These settings remain highly related Gold ORB exposures. The shortlist is for choosing configurations, not evidence of portfolio diversification. Combining selected variants would require separate joint-risk and correlation analysis.

Measured profit and drawdown trade-offs

Profit means net cash profit, excluding the initial deposit; DD means relative equity drawdown

ID	Stop / start	Filter	Trades	Net profit USD	DD %
A	0.25 / 07:05	OFF	1186	112,575.12	17.12
B	0.25 / 07:05	0.00-0.60	1142	68,939.97	15.45
C	0.25 / 07:30	OFF	1149	139,058.89	20.10
D	0.25 / 07:30	0.00-0.60	1106	86,742.66	14.85
E	0.65 / 07:30	OFF	1149	19,545.96	10.60
F	0.65 / 07:30	0.00-0.60	1106	18,452.19	6.93

Filter effect	Profit retained	Profit sacrificed	DD change	Relative DD reduction
A -> B	61.2%	\$43,635.15	17.12% -> 15.45%	9.8%
C -> D	62.4%	\$52,316.23	20.10% -> 14.85%	26.1%
E -> F	94.4%	\$1,093.77	10.60% -> 6.93%	34.6%

A -> B: weak headline trade-off. Net profit falls 38.8%, while DD improves by only 1.67 percentage points. B needs a meaningful improvement elsewhere to justify the added rule.

C -> D: a genuine trade-off. DD improves by 5.25 points, but net profit falls 37.6%. D deserves comparison for a drawdown-led objective; it does not dominate C.

E -> F: strongest filter case. DD improves by 3.67 points, or 34.6% relative, while net profit falls only 5.6%. This is the clearest reason not to discard the range filter entirely.

Profit retention = filtered net profit / unfiltered net profit. Relative DD reduction = (baseline DD - filtered DD) / baseline DD. Percentage-point reduction and relative percentage reduction are different quantities. No future drawdown ceiling is implied.

Why profit retention needs context

Compounding, risk-normalized returns and the small number of removed trades

Pair	Trades removed	Activity retained	Net profit retained
A -> B	44 of 1,186	96.3%	61.2%
C -> D	43 of 1,149	96.3%	62.4%
E -> F	43 of 1,149	96.3%	94.4%

For the narrow stop, removing only about 3.7% of the trades coincides with losing more than a third of compounded net profit. That is an important concentration clue. A few excluded opportunities, especially early gains that would have increased later position sizes, can have a large terminal-balance effect.

Do not conclude that the removed 43 trades directly earned \$52,316.23. The surviving trades are also sized on a different balance path. A valid decomposition must match trade dates and compare normalized outcomes, entry changes, volume rounding and execution rejections.

A more comparable account-growth view

ID	Approx. CAGR*	CAGR / observed equity DD*
A	45.45%	2.66
B	36.19%	2.34
C	49.77%	2.48
D	40.40%	2.72
E	17.58%	1.66
F	16.92%	2.44

The ratio is descriptive, not a selection rule: it rewards high growth and low observed drawdown, but both depend on the historical path. It supports taking F seriously and shows why B is difficult to justify from the headline numbers alone.

* Derived assuming the original \$10,000 deposit and the same 2,443-day configured span, 2020-01-01 to 2026-09-09. Screenshot settings do not independently confirm those assumptions. $CAGR = (ending\ balance / initial\ deposit)^{(365.25 / days)} - 1$. Do not substitute a simple net-profit/DD ratio for a time-normalized comparison.

Evidence from the original 24 passes

07:30 start; two stops, six minimums and two maximums

Min range	Max 0.60 trades	0.25 profit / DD	0.65 profit / DD
0.05	1,106	\$86,743 / 14.85%	\$18,452 / 6.93%
0.10	1,102	\$89,056 / 14.88%	\$18,681 / 7.07%
0.15	1,010	\$56,533 / 14.75%	\$15,078 / 14.58%
0.20	787	\$41,283 / 27.96%	\$12,964 / 15.27%
0.25	548	\$35,607 / 11.30%	\$11,196 / 8.47%
0.30	361 / 360*	\$18,879 / 15.23%	\$6,208 / 7.77%

Minimum 0.05-0.10: the broad acceptance area performs consistently. The difference is only four trades. The small profit improvement at 0.10 is insufficient reason to add a precisely selected lower bound.

Minimum 0.15-0.20: profit deteriorates sharply and drawdown often increases. Rejecting more small ranges is not consistently beneficial. The 0.20 minimum is particularly unattractive on these objectives.

Minimum 0.25-0.30: these create a substantially lower-frequency system. Some have attractive displayed Result values or lower DD, but profit and sample size shrink. At max 0.50/min 0.30, profit is only \$19,206 for 0.25 and \$5,921 for 0.65, with 316 trades each. They do not fit the current preference for retaining return and activity.

The earlier max-0.50 tests remain useful neighbours: at min 0.05, narrow-stop profit/DD is \$88,296.89/14.88%; wide-stop is \$17,782.45/7.45%. Compared with max 0.60, narrow-stop results are similar, while wide-stop results favour 0.60. Thus 0.60 is a practical common cap, not a proven universal optimum.

* Stop 0.25 has 361 trades and 0.65 has 360 at min 0.30/max 0.60. The Journal must explain this discrepancy before claiming stop size never affects eligibility. Result is an optimization-criterion field; the screenshots do not establish that it is profit factor.

What the additional runs establish

Zero-minimum checks and a wider upper bound at both timings

Minimum 0.00 and 0.05 produce identical displayed outputs at max 0.60 and 0.70, at both entry starts and both stops. Zero is therefore the simpler candidate. This does not prove that ranges below 0.05 never occur; they may simply not affect eligible trades in this sample.

Stop / start	Profit: max 0.60	Profit: max 0.70	DD: 0.60 -> 0.70
0.25 / 07:30	\$86,742.66	\$86,740.19	14.85% -> 16.52%
0.25 / 07:05	\$68,939.97	\$66,574.24	15.45% -> 17.05%
0.65 / 07:30	\$18,452.19	\$17,230.66	6.93% -> 8.10%
0.65 / 07:05	\$17,536.31	\$16,480.33	7.92% -> 8.83%

With the minimum at zero, 0.60 has higher profit and lower DD in all four comparisons; the 0.25/07:30 profit difference is negligible. This gives a repeated historical reason to retain 0.60 rather than 0.70. It is stronger evidence than selecting one isolated high-scoring pass.

Why 07:05 is not retained for the wide-stop pair

At range 0.00-0.60, 0.65/07:30 makes \$18,452.19 with 6.93% DD; 0.65/07:05 makes \$17,536.31 with 7.92% DD. The later start wins on both headline metrics. The user reports 12% DD for unfiltered 07:05, so filtering improves its observed DD too. Its unfiltered profit and full report are not available here, preventing a complete matched comparison.

Keeping 07:30 for 0.65 is a provisional narrowing of scope. It does not establish that every omitted timing is inferior on recovery, annual stability or future data.

The three screenshots contain 72 displayed passes, but include exact repeats and overlapping settings. They must not be treated as 72 independent confirmations. Both timings use the same market history and closely related trades.

What stability means here

Separate parameter stability from stability across time and execution models

Dimension	What we know	What remains unproven
Nearby parameters	0.00/0.05 are identical; 0.05/0.10 are close. Max 0.50/0.60 are broadly comparable; 0.70 is weaker.	Whether this behaviour survives unseen data or substantially different execution costs.
Across timings	Max 0.60 beats 0.70 at both starts and stops. Filtered 07:30 has better aggregate profit/DD than filtered 07:05.	Independent replication: the tests share history and many trades.
Across years	Earlier unfiltered analysis: 0.25/07:05 and 07:30 and 0.65/07:30 were positive in each displayed year.	Filtered yearly/monthly distributions, rolling returns and concentration are unavailable from optimization summaries.
Recovery	Earlier unfiltered longest balance recoveries: A 333 days, C 281 days, E 379 days.	Whether the lower filtered maximum DD also shortens time below the previous peak.
Execution	The system uses touch entries, market fills and intrabar stops.	Real-tick versus OHLC differences, slippage, costs and rejected signals for the filtered finalists.

There is encouraging local parameter stability, but it is concentrated around permissive minimums. The sharp deterioration at 0.15-0.20 means the entire parameter space is not stable. Identical results at 0.00 and 0.05 add little independent evidence because the effective trades are the same.

The earlier timing report also found that 0.25/07:30 led full-period return, while 07:05 had lower observed DD and stronger annual returns in 2024-2026. That is why both unfiltered timings survive. A single full-period ranking would hide this regime dependence.

Previously calculated recovery figures refer to closed balance, while headline DD figures refer to equity. They measure different aspects of risk and must not be substituted for one another. Earlier calendar results include partial 2026.

How each candidate can earn selection

Predeclare the questions; do not keep changing the objective after each result

ID	Current standing	Evidence needed next
A	Main narrow-stop risk candidate	Compare its lower DD against C's higher return; verify recent-year advantage and cost robustness.
B	Low-priority filtered challenger	Needs meaningful recovery or weak-period benefits; a small maximum-DD improvement alone does not offset the 38.8% net-profit sacrifice.
C	Main narrow-stop return candidate	Check whether its return advantage remains attractive under conservative sizing and stress; compare directly with D.
D	Filtered narrow-stop risk challenger	Needs a repeatable improvement across periods and recovery, not merely removal of a few inconvenient historical trades.
E	Essential wide-stop baseline	Shows the cost of adding the cap; keep if F's risk benefit fails execution or temporal checks.
F	Leading filtered wide-stop candidate	Confirm that 94.4% profit retention and lower DD persist with full-ledger analysis, costs and real-tick modelling.

A useful additional comparison: lower risk, same rules

A filter is not the only way to reduce drawdown. Rerun the unfiltered finalist at a lower risk setting and compare it with the filtered run at the original setting. This tests whether the new rule delivers something that simpler sizing cannot. Do not scale compounded profits arithmetically; balance-dependent sizing changes the path.

A stopping rule for research

Finish the six matched comparisons, select one or a small number of configurations for forward observation, and stop fine-tuning the minimum/maximum grid unless a concrete validation failure requires a change. Record all attempted settings so unsuccessful searches are not forgotten.

The shortlist is a research decision, not a live-readiness decision. No universal pass thresholds or future profit/DD promises can be justified from these screenshots alone.

Next tests and evidence to export

Keep the experiment matched and preserve the original settings

Step	Action and decision purpose
1. Freeze settings	Save six named .set files. Keep dates, deposit, percentage risk, spread/commission assumptions, EA build, symbol specification and tick mode identical. Only the listed timing/filter choices vary.
2. Obtain detailed runs	Export each native MT5 report with Orders, Deals and Inputs. Reconcile counts, P&L, balances, entry eligibility, sizing and exit reasons. Investigate missing or rejected orders.
3. Compare calendar paths	Calculate annual/monthly and rolling returns, mean R, worst periods, trade concentration, DD episodes and time to recovery. Compare filter ON/OFF on matched dates.
4. Check execution sensitivity	Use 1-minute OHLC only as a fast sensitivity/screening run. Confirm finalists with Every tick based on real ticks. Inspect differing trades instead of ranking systems solely by OHLC totals.
5. Stress risk and costs	Apply realistic commissions/spread/slippage assumptions, losing-sequence/block-resampling checks, and lower-risk unfiltered reruns. Keep analysis assumptions explicit.
6. Freeze and observe	Treat the already examined 2020-2026 sample and 2017-2019 history as research/stress evidence. Preserve genuinely unseen future observations after settings are frozen.

OHLC generates only a few price points per minute and does not reproduce the complete intraminute path. A breakout and a stop can both lie inside the same minute. This makes touch entries and tight stops sensitive to the model; better OHLC profit is not evidence of stronger live execution.

MT5 primary references: [Optimization results and relative equity DD](#); [real ticks, generated ticks and 1-minute OHLC](#). These explain metric/model definitions; all numerical research findings above come from the supplied conversation evidence.

Source scope: this report explains selection using previously reviewed unfiltered results and visible optimization screenshots. It does not claim fresh reconstruction of the filtered trade ledgers, statistical significance, a new Monte Carlo study or unseen-data validation. Currency comparisons assume the same USD account as the earlier exports.